

Utah State Board of Education Charter School Oversight Division
250 East 500 South, PO Box 144200 Salt Lake City, UT 84114-4200

July 2026

Re: Vista Charter School, Ivins, Utah: Formal Parent Grievance

To whom it may concern:

My name is Dr. Megan Milne. I am a board-certified pharmacist and the mother of five children, all of whom have attended Vista Charter School in Ivins, Utah. My oldest attended Vista for ten years. I currently have four children enrolled. Our family has been part of the Vista community for twelve years, and we have chosen Vista year after year because of its extraordinary performing arts program and the dedicated teachers who built it.

I am writing because I believe Vista Charter School is operating in ways that violate its charter, harm students and teachers, and create an environment of retaliation that has gone unaddressed for three years. I am aware that formal grievances were submitted to this board in 2024 by Vista's math teachers documenting the same patterns I am describing now. Those concerns appear to have gone unaddressed. The patterns have continued and expanded to additional departments.

What I have personally witnessed:

In May 2026, my son's third-grade teacher, Mrs. Emily Smith, was placed on administrative leave with no explanation during the week before RISE state testing. My son had been looking forward to testing week because Mrs. Smith had promised to make it special and end with a celebration afterward. Instead, he had substitute teachers, unlicensed paraprofessionals, administering his state assessments. I later learned that Mrs. Smith had been selected by her peers as the best teacher at Vista. She was placed on leave not because of any legitimate concern, but in what appeared to be a retaliatory action by administration. She returned for the last few days of school, leaving my son and his classmates confused and without closure.

I am also aware that it is illegal under federal testing requirements for paraprofessionals to administer RISE assessments to students with IEPs. I am formally requesting that this be investigated.

In June 2026, Vista chose not to renew the contract of Jake Thomas, the school's theater teacher, stage manager, and technical director for every production. He was selected by Vista's ninth graders to speak at their graduation ceremony because he was the most impactful teacher they had. He gave an inspiring speech. Two days later, he was told Vista was "going in a different direction." My ninth-grade daughter, who has been in Vista Rising Stars, Dance Company, Vista Theatre Company, and multiple musicals, was completely heartbroken. Mr. Thomas had a gift for making every student feel seen. He gave each child a nickname and mentored them in ways that went far beyond theater. He was the kind of teacher who shapes

who a person becomes, and for many Vista students, he was irreplaceable. She has struggled to want to return to Vista since learning he was gone.

This phrase, 'going in a different direction,' has been used to dismiss a math teacher, a PE teacher, and now a theater teacher over three consecutive years under the same director. My children loved Coach Klc, who taught PE with joy and creativity. When he was let go with no replacement, my children lost PE entirely for a year. My older children were in the band program that Vista eliminated. They were in the orchestra program and were heartbroken when Linda DeLuca departed.

Vista's charter names exposure to the arts as one of three foundational pillars of the school. Over the past three years, the band program has been eliminated, the choir director has left, the elementary arts teacher has departed, the performing arts coordinator role went unfilled for months, the PE teacher was let go without replacement, and theater, orchestra, and dance have all lost key staff. This is not a series of unrelated personnel decisions. It is a pattern.

Enrollment at Vista has been declining since Dr. Blasko arrived. Some of these families relocated to Southern Utah specifically to enroll their children at Vista, choosing this community because of what this school promised. They have now withdrawn their children and left, or are making plans to do so. I personally know families in both of these situations. Yet despite falling enrollment, the administration is pursuing plans to expand Vista into a high school. I am formally asking this board not to approve a high school expansion while the original K-9 school is in this condition. The foundation must be stable before the building can grow.

I am asking this board to investigate whether Vista Charter School is operating in compliance with its charter, whether RISE testing was administered in compliance with federal requirements, and whether the school's leadership environment meets the standard of a safe and professional workplace. I am also asking this board not to approve a high school expansion for Vista while the original K-9 school is experiencing declining enrollment and program instability.

Dr. Blasko has a documented history of creating a toxic work environment at his prior position. In December 2021, the Monroe School District Board in Washington state placed him on paid administrative leave following concerns from staff and community members about his leadership. The board hired an independent third-party investigator, whose findings led to a formal separation agreement. Dr. Blasko signed it and resigned on July 31, 2022. This was publicly communicated by the Monroe School District Board to its entire community. The same patterns that prompted that investigation are present at Vista today.

I am not writing alone. A coalition of Vista families has been documenting these concerns across four categories: students, finances, teachers, and charter compliance. Additional letters from parents, teachers, and alumni are being submitted.

Thank you for your attention to this matter.

Sincerely,

Dr. Megan Milne, PharmD, BCACP

Vista parent since 2014 • Five children at Vista • Ivins, Utah